

Furman Pauper Players Constitution

Updated Fall 2021

Introduction: Founding

In 1992, an ambitious and talented sophomore named Mary Mitchell Campbell noticed that one form of the arts was glaringly absent from Furman's campus—musical theatre. At the time, a musical had not been staged at Furman since a production of "South Pacific" twenty-seven years prior. Campbell had found her mission; she gathered a group of interested friends and vowed to end musical theatre's invisibility. The Furman Pauper Players, named so on account of the group's meager, personally supplied budget, marked the beginning of a new era with their first entirely student-run production of "Nunsense." In the subsequent year, Campbell continued to astound audiences, often parents at Parents' Weekend, with her delightful interpretations of musicals like "Godspell" and "Joseph and the Amazing Technicolor Dreamcoat." Campbell's legacy will continue through primarily student-run musical theatre productions. She began what undoubtedly has become a beloved Furman tradition.

Article I: Name

The name of this organization is the Furman Pauper Players (FPP).

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of FPP is twofold:

1. To perform quality musical theatre productions at Furman University.
2. To provide motivated students of any major or background with the opportunity to sharpen their skills in leadership, communication, performance, cooperation, and responsibility.

Article III: Membership

Section I.

Any interested Furman students are welcome to become members of FPP. After involvement in just one show, a student is considered to be a member of FPP. While auditions are necessary for any stage production, interested students and FPP members who are not cast in any given show will be invited to help with offstage facets of the production—lighting, sound, costumes, props, publicity etc. All members are subject to the terms of this constitution.

Section II.

Members of FPP are eligible to apply for FPP council if they have participated in at least one musical or Cabaret in the last two semesters that they have been on campus. While the shows are being affected by Covid-19 this rule does not apply. Any eligible member of FPP can become a member of the FPP Council by going through the application process released by the current council during the Spring semester.

Section III.

All members of Pauper Players are always bound by University conduct policies, including when representing Pauper Players. If a member is found to have violated the Student Code of Conduct at a Pauper Players event, rehearsal, or performance in any capacity, they will find themselves ineligible to audition for future Pauper Players performances.

Section IV.

Alcohol, drugs, or any other items prohibited by the student conduct code are not permitted under any circumstances at Pauper Players performances, rehearsals, or events.

Article IV: Council

Section I: Members of Council

The Council will comprise experienced Pauper Players selected through an application process explained in Section V. By a majority vote, the size of Council can increase or decrease as deemed necessary by the current Council. Members of Council are responsible for making executive decisions regarding the performance calendar, show selection, director selection, and any other administrative aspect of the organization.

Members of Council who do not hold executive officer positions can perform executive duties in the absence of the elected officers as decided upon by the president. These members can also serve on ad hoc committees formed throughout the year.

Section II: Executive Officers and Responsibilities

The President shall be responsible for:

- A. Presiding over Council meetings.
- B. Acting as the primary ambassador of FPP to the university.
- C. Delegating responsibilities to members of the Council and forming ad hoc committees.
- D. Counting votes during Council meetings.

The Treasurer shall be responsible for:

- A. All fiscal business of FPP, which includes writing checks, withdrawing and depositing money. The use of a debit card is advised against.
- B. Creating a budget to submit to the Student Government Association.
- C. Working together with SGA to alter the budget should any changes be necessary.
- D. Deciding upon allocations of the budget in coordination with the directors of each show. Allocations are to be presented to the Council and voted on by a majority vote.
- E. Working with the director(s) of each show to keep them aware of their budget allowances and limitations.
- F. Refunding those who spent money for FPP from the FPP bank account with the Bank of Traveler's Rest.
- G. Acquiring reimbursement from SGA.
- H. Making financial reports at Council meetings as appropriate.

The Secretary shall be responsible for:

- A. Taking roll at the start of each Council meeting.
- B. Taking minutes at each Council meeting.
- C. Sending the minutes to all members of the Council and its advisors.
- D. Promoting communication within the Council itself.
- E. Keeping a list of the active members of FPP.
- F. Collecting votes during Council meetings and recounting the votes after the President.
- G. Maintaining and updating the Constitution and Bylaws.

The Events Coordinator shall be responsible for:

- A. Coordinating all Pauper Players events aside from the two major musical productions.
- B. Reserving the space for such events if necessary.
- C. Serving as the liaison between Council and the Director of the Cabaret.

The Publicity Committee shall comprise the Public Relations Chair and Social Media Chair.

The Public Relations Chair shall be responsible for:

- A. Publicizing FPP auditions, performances, and other events around the university and in the community.
- B. Publicizing FPP itself.
- C. Obtaining assistance from any members of FPP for publicity purposes whenever necessary.
- D. Making publicity reports at Council meetings as appropriate.
- E. Ordering cups and stickers for the Student Involvement Fair in the Fall.

The Social Media Chair shall be responsible for:

- A. Publicizing all the above mentioned FPP events through social media accounts including but not limited to Facebook and Instagram.
- B. Updating SyncDin

The Morale Chair shall be responsible for:

- A. Snacks and water for the cast during Tech Week of the two major musicals.

- B. Getting thank you notes for the production teams of the two major musicals.
- C. Coordinating with PR chair to create and distribute general Pauper Players apparel (T-shirts, hats, etc)

"The Members at Large will be responsible for:

- A. Serving as a Delegate during productions such as cabarets and main stage shows
- B. Supporting Executive Council members in their responsibilities when needed
- C. Will coordinate the front of house for main stage production

The delegate shall be responsible for:

- A. Attending all production team meetings.
- B. Serving as an extra liaison between Council and the production team.
- C. Voicing concerns of the Council to the production team.
- D. The delegate should not already be a part of the production team.
- E. The delegate is permitted to hold another executive position.

Section III: Meetings

The FPP Council will meet once a week at a regular time decided upon by the Council members. At each meeting, officers will make their weekly reports and any other necessary business will be made known. FPP business should be kept private and should not be discussed outside of meetings. Each member of Council will be allowed two unexcused absences each semester. For an absence to be excused, you must tell the secretary prior to the meeting.

Section IV: Council Presence

The FPP Council is to serve the role of producers for each of its productions and its presence needs to be felt by the members of FPP. All members of Council, if they are not already involved in the production, are required to attend at least one rehearsal to check up on progress and see if anything needs to be done by the Council to aid the director or the progress of the show. Each member will report their rehearsal attendance and observations at the following Council meeting.

Section V: Council Applications: Officer Selection

Members of FPP are eligible to apply for FPP council if they have participated in at least one musical or Cabaret in the last two semesters that they have been on campus. Any eligible member of FPP can become a member of the FPP council by going through the application process released by the current council during the Spring semester. Any members of council who wish to remain on council must re-apply. Each new officer is chosen by a majority vote of the graduating seniors and any current Council members that are not running for the position in question. The appropriate size of the Council will be determined by the current Council with a minimum of seven members and maximum of ten.

Section VI: Council Applications: Members at Large Selection

After the seven officers are selected, the three Members at Large will be elected by a popular vote of the entire Pauper membership. Any applicant who was not selected for an officer position is included on the ballot. Voting opens immediately after officer selection and must remain open for at least 72 hours. After voting has closed and before the next council meeting, the Incoming President, Incoming Treasurer, and Outgoing President will view the results of the vote and make the final decision on the three Members at Large should any ties occur.

Section VII: Provisions for Recall

Members of FPP Council may be removed from the Council for malfeasance in the office.

The issue must be brought to the President who will set up a meeting with the Council Member in question. A neutral third Council Member who did not bring up the original complaint will also be present at this meeting. Depending on the discussion, the membership of the Council Member in question may or may not be brought to a vote at the following council meeting, and the offending member may be removed if 70% of Council members agree.

If the member of Council with the complaint is the President, or the offending member of Council is the President, the issue must be brought to the Secretary who will set up a meeting with the Council Member in question. A neutral third Council Member who did not bring up the original complaint will also be present at this meeting. Depending on the discussion, the membership of the Council Member in question

may or may not be brought to a vote at the following council meeting, and the offending member may be removed if 70% of Council members agree.

Article V: Shows

Section I: Director and Show Selection

Any member of FPP, regardless of their position in the organization, is eligible to direct a FPP show. A student interested in directing must choose the show that they would like to direct and form a proposal to be presented at a Council meeting. The proposal should include creative concepts for the music and set design, where the show will be performed, potential crew members, and a tentative timeline for rehearsals and tech week. After all interested parties have made their proposals, the FPP Council will discuss and choose by a two-thirds majority vote the directors and shows for the upcoming season. Shows and directors for the next season will be decided upon by the end of the Spring semester the school year before the upcoming season. Following the Director Selection Process, the Council will release an additional application for Fall Cabaret Directors. Spring Cabaret Directors will be chosen by the end of the Fall semester prior to the Spring Cabaret.

Section II: Responsibilities of the Director

The responsibilities of the directors are as follows:

- A. Complete responsibility for the show and has at his/her disposal the allocated resources of FPP Council.
- B. During the preparations for the show, the FPP Council can request to meet with the director at any time to give feedback and suggestions.
- C. Communicate regularly with the cast, crew, and Council members to make sure that preparations are going smoothly and are within the show's budget.
- D. Attend meetings during the production of their show when needed.
- E. Selecting crew members with the assistance of the Council, including but not limited to: Assistant Director, Music Director, Stage Manager, Technical Director, Lighting Designer, Set Designer, Costume Manager, Props Manager, Publicity Manager, and Choreographer.
- F. Larger scale shows must have at least two people in charge; the director and his/her assistant (who may be, for example, the Music Director or Technical Director).
- G. Deciding upon the attendance policy for rehearsals and making it known to cast and crew at the very beginning of production.
- H. Act in a professional manner at all times, since they are representing the entire organization.
- I. If a cast or crew member is not fulfilling his/her responsibilities by coming to rehearsal and learning music and lines, the director has the authority to remove them from the show and find a replacement if necessary.
- J. Ensuring that a playbill is made for their production.
- K. If FPP Council feels that a director is not fulfilling the aforementioned requirements, the Council may replace the director with a majority vote.
 - a. The issue must be brought to the President who will set up a meeting with the Director. A neutral third Council Member or member of the production team who did not bring up the original complaint will also be present at this meeting. Depending on the discussion, the removal of the Director may or may not be brought to a vote at the following council meeting which will include all members of the Production Team, and the offending Director may be removed if 70% of Council members and every member of the Production Team agrees.
 - b. Should the Director be removed from his/her position, the Council and Production Team will vote on the New Director. In order for someone to be chosen as the New Director, the Production Team must be unanimous and Council must reach a majority.

Sections III: Rehearsals

Rehearsals will occur several times a week for a minimum of four weeks for any given show. Attendance is mandatory at all rehearsals for called cast and crew members. Individual cast members should practice at home in order to increase the efficiency and productivity of group rehearsals. If a rehearsal is missed, it is the individual's responsibility to learn and practice the missed material. The director must

decide at the onset of a production what the attendance policy for rehearsals will be; the cast and crew must be notified of the policy at the very beginning of production.

Section IV: Performances

The number of performances for any given FPP show will vary, though it should not be excessive and, thus, grueling. The times and places of performances will be known at the time of director and show selection the Spring semester prior to the season.

Article VI: Faculty Involvement

Section I: Advisor

The advisor of FPP is any supportive and willing Furman faculty or staff member who will serve as a non-voting member of the organization. The advisor shall assist the group in the execution of roles and responsibilities, provide feedback to the organization regarding its operation and function, and serve as a resource to FPP, sharing knowledge, expertise, and experience with the group.

Section II: Liaison from the Music Department

The liaison from the music department is any Furman music faculty member willing to give his/her support to FPP. The liaison from the music department will assist FPP with synchronizing the music department's and FPP's calendars and encouraging support for the organization from the other members of the music faculty.

Section III: Liaison from the Theatre Department

The liaison from the theatre department is any theatre faculty member willing to give his/her support to FPP. The liaison from the theatre department will assist FPP with synchronizing the theatre department's and FPP's calendars and encouraging support for the organization from the other members of the theatre faculty.

Section IV: Restrictions

FPP is a completely student-run organization, and faculty advisors and/or liaisons will not be allowed to choose Council members, serve on the Council, and choose directors or shows. Council will inform advisors of any pertinent information.

Article VII: Provisions for Amending the Constitution

Amendments may be made to the FPP Constitution by a majority vote of the members of FPP Council.

Furman Pauper Players Bylaws

Updated Spring 2021

Article I- The President

- Section 1: The President of Pauper Players Council cannot direct or serve as stage manager for a show.
- Section 2: The President is the spokesperson for members of the cast should there be any issues with the production team.
- Whether or not he or she agrees with the rest of the cast, the president will speak in their defense and in their best interests, regardless of if they are in the cast or not.
- Section 3: The President is the liaison between council and the production team, the theatre department, and music department.
- Section 4: The President is allowed to intervene with the production team should there be any issues.
- Section 5: Must prepare an agenda for Council meetings.

Article II- The Treasurer

- Section 1: Must make a budget report when appropriate.
- Section 2: Reimbursements to the production team and payments to the orchestra must be made in a timely manner.
- Section 3: Reallocations can be made without a Council vote so long as the Treasurer and Director are in agreement and the reallocations are approved by SGA.
- Must make a report about reallocations in meetings.
- Section 4: Must allocate and submit a budget to SGA at the end of the school year.

Article III- The Secretary

- Section 1: Must take minutes in all Council meetings and send them to the Council and advisors where appropriate regardless of how insignificant they may seem.
- Section 2: Is responsible for reserving rooms for all meetings.

Article IV- Events Coordinator

- Section 1: Serves as Front of House during the two major musicals.
- Section 2: Plans and facilitates all Pauper Players events outside of the two musicals including but not limited to Cabaret, Senior Showcase, and karaoke nights.

Article V- Publicity Committee

- Section 1: Public Relations Chair
- Responsible for publicizing FPP auditions, performances, and other events around the university and in the community.

- Must work collaboratively with the social media chair and director for advertising campaigns.
- Section 2: Social Media Chair
- Responsible for updating social media accounts including but not limited to Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram.
 - Responsible for distributing newsletters when necessary.
 - Must Instagram and Tweet:
 - Once a week during rehearsals for a show.
 - Every day the week of the show.
 - Twice a month when no show is in production.
 - And for special events.

Article VI- Morale Chair

- Section 1: Get snacks and water for the cast during Tech Week of the two major musicals.
- Section 2: Get thank you notes for the production teams of the two major musicals.
- Section 3: Order cups and stickers for the Student Involvement Fair in the Fall.
- Section 4: Coordinating general Pauper Players apparel (T-shirts, hats, etc)

Article VII- Members of Council

- Section 1: If a member of Council is applying to direct a show, he or she may not be involved in the show decision making process.
- Section 2: If a member of Council is included on a potential production team they may be involved in the show selection process including voting privileges.
- Section 3: During the production of a show, a member may voice concerns to any member of council who will then communicate it with the production team.
- Section 4: Members of Council should be involved in at least one mainstage production or Cabaret every year.
- Section 5: Is responsible for maintaining and updating the Constitution and Bylaws.
- Section 6: Council members are the face of Pauper Players and should conduct themselves appropriately.

Article VIII- Director and Production Rules

- Section 1: Any music major or theatre majors who wish to audition are encouraged to notify and gain permission from their respective teachers.
- Section 2: Students may not miss classes or music lessons for Pauper Players rehearsals.
- Section 3: Schedules for all rehearsals including tech week must include call time, start time, and end time.
- Section 4: Rehearsals must always start and end at the times specified on the schedule.
- Section 5: Rehearsals will end no later than 10:00pm before tech week or 10:30pm during tech week.
- Any rehearsal extending past these times must be approved by the members of the cast.
- Section 6: Notes following tech week rehearsals will only be group notes.
- Section 7: Individual notes will be given individually when needed.
- Section 8: Cast will warm up together during tech week and the days of the show, enforced by the council.
- Section 9: Directors must keep in constant contact with the McAlister staff all throughout production.
- Section 10: Directors must send the President and Danielle a weekly update of progress from the time their show is selected all the way through strike.
- Section 11: All members of Pauper Players should keep in mind that we are a student organization and the spaces we use are a privilege and not a right. We must always treat them with respect and take proper care of them by following all guidelines and instructions from the owners and operators of all spaces on campus and the production team who is interacting with them.
- Section 12: Props, costumes, and personal items (water bottles, bags etc.) are to be placed on the ground, a designated table, or a dressing room and not in other areas.

Section 13: One member of council (likely a member at large) will be assigned to each performance (cabarets included) for risk management to ensure that the Student Conduct Code is being followed and the space is being treated with respect and care.

Article IX- Council Meetings

- Section 1: Council meetings will be scheduled to occur once a week.
- Meetings must be held during the production of shows.
 - Meetings held during the production of shows may include the director along with other members of the production team if desired.
- Section 2: Council meetings that include the director are the time for the director to update Council on the production process and for Council to voice concerns to the director.
- Section 3: Attendance will be taken at each meeting by the Secretary. Any more than 2 unexcused absences will result in probation for the remainder of the semester. Two consecutive semesters of probation result in dismissal from the FPP Council.
- Section 4: The secretary will collect votes during Council meetings and recount the votes after the President.

Article X- Council Applications and Officer Elections

- Section 1: To apply to Council, an applicant must have participated in at least one show in the last two semesters they were on campus.
- Section 2: Officer elections must happen before the director selection process.
- Section 3: Application forms are written and revised by the current council as seen fit.
- Section 4: The maximum size of Council is ten members and the minimum size of Council is six members.
- Section 5: Council members who wish to serve another year must re-apply for an officer position or run for a spot as a Member at Large.
- Section 6: Each officer position is chosen by the graduating seniors and any current Council members that are not running for the specific position.
- Section 7: After the 7 officer positions are filled, the 3 Members at Large are selected from the pool of remaining applicants by a popular vote of the general FPP membership.
- Section 8: The Outgoing President, Incoming President, and Incoming Treasurer will be able to view the results of the vote and make the final decision on the 3 Members at Large should any ties occur.
- Section 9: Former officers will teach the newly elected officers about their duties. If a former officer is not re-elected onto Council, they will not have a vote in show selection.

Article XI- Director and Show Selection

- Section 1: Director applications will be released by Council following closing night of the Spring show and two weeks prior to the deadline.
- Section 2: Director applications will be discussed one week before the interview process and we will vote on who gets an interview.
- Section 3: To receive an interview, a director needs to receive a simple majority. Voting will occur after each director has been discussed.
- Section 4: Each director and show will be discussed by the Council in an open forum. Pro-con is recommended to keep comments balanced, though the Council may conduct how they see fit.
- Section 5: The interview process will comprise a brief reiteration of their pitch followed by questions from Council members until all concerns have been satisfied.
- Section 6: No time limit will be set for each interview.
- Section 7: The directors and shows will be voted on as a full season and will require a two-thirds majority vote.